

BALANCING FAITH AND WORLDLY LIFE

LIVING IN THE WORLD WHILE
PREPARING FOR THE HEREAFTER

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***In the Name of Allah,
the All-beneficent,
the All-merciful.***

Preface

In today's fast-paced world, particularly in the Subcontinent, young people struggle to balance **faith (dīn) and worldly life (dunyā)**. Society often presents these two as conflicting, leading to confusion:

- If you focus on faith, it feels like you are **falling behind in worldly success**.
- If you focus on the world, it seems like **you are losing your connection with faith**.

This booklet provides authentic, logical, and practical solutions derived from:

- The Qur'ān
- Nahj al-Balāgha
- Şahīfa al-Sajjādiyya

- Sayings of the Ahl al-Bayt (‘alayhimus-salām)

Through this booklet, you will learn how to:

- Understand the balance between dīn and dunyā
- Clarify your life goals
- Achieve consistency in faith and action
- Avoid worldly distractions while attaining spiritual success
- Prioritize the hereafter while fulfilling worldly responsibilities

Let us explore these issues step by step, paving the way for young individuals to lead a **balanced and purposeful life**. Remember, this booklet is neither the **first nor the last** discussion on this subject, as Islamic teachings are **vast and ever-revealing**. Therefore,

continue this journey of research
and self-improvement.

— **Syed Imon Rizvi**

March 21, 2025 / 21st Ramadhān
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*Dedicated to the
esteemed teacher,
Shaheed Ustād
Sibt-e-Ja'far*

Chapter 1: Are Faith and Worldly Success Opposed to Each Other?

Key Question: Can We Succeed in Both?

Many young people feel trapped in a **conflict between faith and worldly success**. However, Islam does not separate the two but provides a **comprehensive principle**:

"Seek the abode of the Hereafter by means of what Allah has given you, while not forgetting your share of this world."
(Surah al-Qaşaş 28:77)

"And when the prayer is finished disperse through the land and seek

*Allah's grace, and remember Allah much so that you may be felicitous.”
(Surah al-Jumu‘ah 62:10)*

Lesson:

Islam does not command us to abandon the world but rather to use the world as a means for the hereafter while fulfilling our responsibilities.

Imām ‘Alī’s Guidance on Life’s Priorities

In **Nahj al-Balāgha (Sermon 269)**, Imām ‘Alī (‘alayhis-salām) distinguishes between two types of people:

1 Those who live solely for this world.

2 Those who live in this world but for the hereafter.

Imām clearly highlights that we should be like the second group—using this life as a preparation for the next.

"Work for your worldly life as if you will live forever, and work for your afterlife as if you will die tomorrow."
(*Wasā'il al-Shī'a*, Vol. 2, p. 535, *Ḥadīth No. 2*)

Lesson:

This golden principle teaches us to **balance both aspects of life** while ensuring that **our focus remains on the hereafter.**

Chapter 2: Clarifying Your Life Goals – What Are You Really Chasing?

The Struggle of Today's Youth

Many young people today are uncertain about their life goals. Society pushes them towards wealth, fame, and temporary pleasures, but these do not bring true peace.

Pleasure and **peace** are two different things. Pleasure is instant or temporary, and its effect fades after a while, whereas peace is a lasting feeling that can only be attained by fulfilling one's responsibilities and duties. When a person shifts their focus from fleeting pleasures to true peace, they will naturally turn towards

Allah, for the Qur'ān states that **the remembrance of Allah brings tranquility and peace to the hearts.**

Moreover, remembrance is not just verbal; it is a continuous state of consciousness. The true benefit of dhikr (remembrance) is realized while carrying out worldly tasks, for it is this very remembrance that protects one from harām, keeps one away from evil, and leads them towards true success.

True Success According to the Qur'ān

Now, what is true success? Let us ask the Qur'ān:

"Every soul shall taste death, and you will indeed be paid your full rewards on the Day of Resurrection. Whoever is delivered from the Fire

*and admitted to paradise has certainly **succeeded**. The life of this world is nothing but the wares of **delusion**.”*

(Surah Āl ‘Imrān 3:185)

Lesson:

True success is only in attaining Paradise through obedience to Allah and His Messenger (ṣallallāhu ‘alayhi wa-ālihi wa-sallam). Remember, our ultimate goal should be the Hereafter, and this world should be merely a means to achieve that purpose.

Practical Steps to Define Your Goals

- **List Your Priorities** – Faith, career, family, etc.
- **Align Them with Islamic Values** – Ask yourself: "Does this bring me closer to Allah?"

- **Create a Balanced Schedule**
 - Allocate time for prayer, work, family, and self-growth.
- **Regularly Reflect** – Is your worldly pursuit pulling you away from your ultimate purpose?

We continuously recite this Qur'ānic verse in the qunūt of our prayers:

"Our Lord, grant us good in this world and good in the Hereafter."
(*Surah al-Baqarah 2:201*)

Imām Zayn al-‘Ābidīn (‘alayhis-salām), in Du‘ā Makārim al-Akhlāq, makes Allah’s love the means for achieving perfection in both this world and the Hereafter, praying:

"And make an easy path for me to reach Your love, and through it,

complete for me the goodness of both this world and the Hereafter."

Lesson:

Seek Allah's love first—it will bring balance and success in both worlds.

Chapter 3: Consistency in Faith – The Key to True Success

Many young people practice faith for a short time but struggle to remain consistent.

In Nahj al-Balāgha, in the letter of guidance addressed to Imām Ḥasan (‘alayhis-salām), Imām ‘Alī (‘alayhis-salām) states:

"Acquire insight into religious law. Habituate yourself to endure hardships since the best trait of character is endurance in matters of righteousness."

(Nahj al-Balāgha, Letter 31 to Imām Ḥasan ‘alayhis-salām)

Lesson:

Success comes not through short bursts of faith but through long-term consistency.

Practical Steps to Build Consistency

- Set Small Faith-Based Goals (e.g., *never miss Fajr prayer*).
- Surround Yourself with Good Company – The Prophet (ṣallallāhu ‘alayhi wa-ālihi wa-sallam) said:
"A good companion is one whose presence reminds you of Allah, whose speech increases your knowledge, and whose actions remind you of the hereafter." (*Bihār al-Anwār, Vol. 15, p. 751*)
- **Seek Knowledge** – Read Islamic books, attend lectures, and engage with scholars.

- Make Du‘ā’ for Guidance –
"Guide us on the straight path, (6) the path of those whom You have blessed — such as have not incurred Your wrath, nor are astray."
(*Surah al-Fātiḥa* 6-7)

Chapter 4: The Reality of This World – Avoid Its Traps

Many youth get **lost in materialism**, believing that wealth, fame, and luxury define success.

But reality is different:
Imam Ali mentions the true value of world in Nahj al-Balāgha:

"The world is like a snake—soft to the touch but filled with deadly poison." (*Nahj al-Balāgha, Letter 68*)

In reality, the ignorant fall into the deception of this world, while the wise remain cautious of its dangers. Just like innocent and unaware children often grab hold

of dangerous objects because they do not understand their risks, whereas their parents prevent them from touching such things to protect them from harm.

To erase the illusion of the world's glitter and attraction, this saying of Imām 'Alī ('alayhis-salām) is enough:

"By Allah, your world is worth less to me than a pig's intestines in the hands of a leper." (*Nahj al-Balāgha, Saying 236*)

Lesson:

The world is **temporary and deceptive**. Use it wisely, but do not let it control you.

Conclusion: The Path to a Balanced Life

Key Takeaways:

- **Do not separate dīn and dunyā** – Carry them together.
- **Clarify your goals** – Ensure every action aligns with Allah's pleasure.
- **Stay consistent in faith** – Build spiritual discipline.
- **Do not be deceived by the world** – Prioritize the hereafter.
- **Seek Allah's guidance in every step** – **Du'ā' and reliance on Him bring true success.**
- "While living in this world, take only as much provision from it as will save your souls tomorrow." (*Nahj al-Balāgha, Sermon 28*)

Final Message

Be in this world, but do not let the ***world*** define you.